

Automation Starter Checklist

CoreIQ Create — 10 steps before you build anything

Step 1 — List manual tasks

Write down every task that repeats more than twice a week. Include estimated time per occurrence.

Step 2 — Identify the trigger

For each task: what starts it? A time, an event, a human action, or an incoming message?

Step 3 — Map the data flow

What goes in? What comes out? What systems does it touch? Draw it, even if rough.

Step 4 — Check if it already exists

Search Zapier, Make.com, and n8n templates before building. 80% of common automations are pre-built.

Step 5 — Score by ROI

Score each task: $(\text{minutes saved/week}) \times (\text{weeks/year}) \div (\text{hours to build})$. Prioritise score > 10.

Step 6 — Build the simplest version

One trigger. One action. No branching. Get it working first, then add complexity.

Step 7 — Add error handling

What happens if step 3 fails? Add: a notification, a fallback, and a log entry.

Step 8 — Test with real data

Never test automations with production data first. Use a test record. Check every edge case.

Step 9 — Document it

Write a 5-line SOT: what it does, what triggers it, what it writes to, who owns it, how to turn it off.

Step 10 — Set a review date

Calendar reminder in 30 days. Automations break silently. Check: is it still running? Is the output still correct?

Built by CoreIQ Create — coreiqcreate-ten.vercel.app